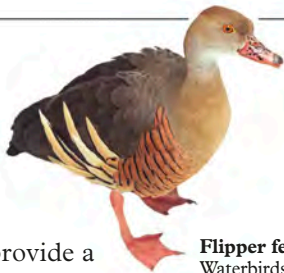


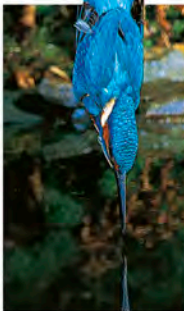
LAKES AND RIVERS



Flipper feet

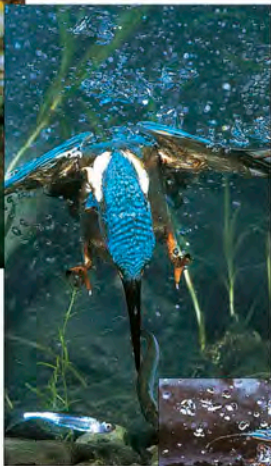
Waterbirds have webbed feet. They use these webs of skin like flippers, to push through the water.

Still lakes and flowing rivers provide a well-stocked pantry for flocks of ducks, geese, swans, and many more unusual birds. Wherever you live in the world, you can spot these wonderful waterbirds bobbing around on the surface or paddling in the shallows, for they are not shy of people and live on lakes and rivers in cities, too.



Splash!

The brilliant blue kingfisher plunges into rivers to catch minnows that are half the length of its body. With its wings folded and its eyes and nostrils tightly shut, the kingfisher flies into the water. It has to struggle to free itself from the pull of the water, but it soon succeeds and flies away with its fish.



Treading water

These western grebes are dancing. When the birds have paired up, they dance across the lake together. Often, a male bird will try to steal another's partner!



Water skiing



Touchdown

Gathering speed



Liftoff



Water-runways

Heavy waterbirds can't land or take off on the spot. Like airplanes, they need runways!